

Poland

Poland.....	1
1. Study Courses That Qualify (Claud)	1
2. Embassy/Consulate Appointment	1
3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa	2
4. Documents to Prepare	2
5. Money Requirements	3
6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival.....	3
7. Working While Studying.....	4
8. Renewing the Residence Permit.....	4
9. Changing to a Work Permit After Studies	5
10. Official Government Information.....	5
11. Official Application Forms	6
12. Common Mistakes & Tips	6
1. Study Courses (Gemini)	7
2. Embassy Appointment	7
3. Applying for a Study Visa	7
4. Documents Needed.....	8
5. Money Requirements	8
6. Residence Permit	8
7. Working While Studying.....	9
8. Renewing the Residence Permit.....	9
9. Changing to a Work Permit	9
10. Official Information.....	10
11. Application Forms	10
12. Tips for Students (Common Mistakes to Avoid)	10

1. Study Courses That Qualify (Claud)

The relevant visa/permit category covers higher education study: National visas (marked with D symbol and annotation '09', 'student') or temporary residence permits for the purpose of studying at a higher education institution are issued to third-country nationals, whose purpose of stay in Poland are full-time studies or PhD studies justifying stay for a period longer than 3 months. [European Commission](#)

Importantly, not every institution automatically qualifies: the higher education institution should be approved by the Minister of the Interior for the purpose of admission of third-country students. Public and non-public University-type higher education institutions (HEIs) as well as public professional HEIs are exempted from the approval obligation. So if you're enrolling at a public university or recognized HEI, you're generally covered automatically; smaller or non-standard providers should be checked against the official approval list. [European Commission](#)

There's also a special "student mobility" pathway if you're already studying in another EU country and want to do part of your degree in Poland — you may carry out part of your studies and work in Poland... **you may reside and study in Poland for up to 360 days, provided your existing programme involves an EU/multilateral mobility agreement - official EU Immigration Portal does not specify this exact number; the first permit is granted for 2 years for EU programme students** . [European Commission](#)

2. Embassy/Consulate Appointment

Booking goes through Poland's dedicated portal: the visa application can be completed online and printed, however there is no possibility to apply for a visa online. The only electronically operated part of the visa application procedure is the reservation of the date and time of the meeting in the consulate and registration of the application via the e-Konsulat portal. [European Commission](#)

In practice: in most cases, you will have to register through the website: <https://secure.e-konsulat.gov.pl/>. After registering, printed and signed applications should be submitted to the consular offices. In some locations (Belarus, China, India, Philippines, Turkey and Ukraine), applications can be submitted via the External Service Provider (commonly VFS Global), where staff can help you fill in the form. [Study in Poland](#)[European Commission](#)

A practical tip from official consulate guidance: appointments for Schengen visa as well as national visa registrations for the purpose other than employment are made available systematically in the "Register Form" of the e-konsulat system every first

Wednesday of the month — slots are released on a first-come-first-served basis, so it's worth checking the portal right when new slots open. [Gov.pl](#)

3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa

Two-stage process: first the national visa (D-type) from abroad, then a temporary residence permit after arrival if you're staying past the visa's validity.

Documents needed for the visa: completed visa application form; valid travel document (validity expiring no earlier than 3 months after the visa expiry, with at least two blank pages, issued within the past 10 years); up-to-date biometric photograph; proof of payment of the visa fee, plus the supporting documents listed in Question 4. [European Commission](#)

How to apply: Register and book your consulate appointment via e-Konsulat → print and sign the application → submit in person with documents and fee at the consulate (or ESP/VFS centre in some countries).

How long it takes: a national visa or a decision refusing to issue this visa shall be issued within 30 days from the date of submission of the application together with the documents necessary to confirm the data contained in the application. If anything's missing, the applicant has the right to supplement them within 7 days from the date of submission of the application. [European Commission](#)[European Commission](#)

4. Documents to Prepare

Beyond the basic visa form and passport, you'll need: a certificate of an entity conducting studies concerning the enrolling for their study programme... evidence of payment of the fee for studies if applicable; documents confirming the third-country national is covered by public health insurance in Poland or the confirmation of the private insurer's coverage of the medical treatment costs on the territory of Poland. Health insurance has a specific threshold for visa applicants: travel medical insurance for a minimum sum insured of 30,000 euros, valid for the period of the intended stay... covering repatriation for medical reasons, urgent medical attention, emergency hospital treatment or death. [European Commission](#)[European Commission](#)

You also need proof of financial resources (see Question 5) and proof of accommodation.

5. Money Requirements

This is calculated as a precise monthly minimum, tied to costs of living separately from accommodation: the amount of monthly funds, upon deducting the funds dedicated to cover the costs of residence, should exceed 776 PLN for single persons or 600 PLN for persons in the family. [European Commission](#)

You also need to budget for **return travel costs**, with the figure depending on where you're traveling from: acceptable amounts are 200 PLN in case of arrival from a neighbouring country, 500 PLN from other EU/EEA Member States or Switzerland, 2500 PLN from other countries. [European Commission](#)

Acceptable proof includes student loan/scholarship documentation, a parental sponsorship statement, or your own bank statements — and don't forget, you also need to show you can cover the cost of your studies themselves, not just living expenses.

6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival

This is the **Temporary Residence Permit**, applied for at the local **Voivodship (Provincial) Office**: the third-country national makes the application in person, no later than on the last day of the lawful residence on the territory of Poland, to the governmental province authority (voivode) competent in respect of his/her place of residence. You should make an appointment early enough. [European Commission](#)

Biometrics are collected during this process: while submitting the application, the third-country national is under the obligation to give his/her fingerprints. [European Commission](#)

Costs: stamp duty PLN 340 (approx. 77 euros). Fee for issuing a residence card PLN 100 (approx. 23 euros). [European Commission](#)

Timing: the procedure should end within 60 days from the day of making a complete application. The third-country national who has obtained the temporary residence permit is issued with a residence card. [European Commission](#)

7. Working While Studying

Yes — and notably, Poland places **no specific hour cap** on student work, unlike many other EU countries: holders of a national visa with a 'student' annotation or temporary residence permit for the purpose of studying at a higher education institution may perform work in Poland without the need to have a work permit. The residence card, issued in connection with temporary residence permit, includes apart from an annotation 'student', also an annotation 'access to the labour market.' [European Commission](#)

You can also start a business: holders of the temporary residence permit issued for that purpose may undertake and conduct business activity on the territory of the Republic of Poland on the same terms as Polish citizens. [European Commission](#)

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

The first permit is intentionally generous in length, often covering more than one academic year already:

The first temporary residence permit for the purpose of studies is granted for a period of 15 months. If the studies justify the stay of a third-country national on the territory of Poland for a period shorter than 15 months, the first permit is granted for the term of the academic year or the studies, extended by 3 months. [European Commission](#)

If your programme involves an EU mobility agreement: where the studies are covered by an EU programme or a multilateral programme involving mobility measures or an agreement between at least two higher education institutions, the first temporary residence permit is granted for 2 years. [European Commission](#)

For longer programmes, subsequent renewals follow: a subsequent temporary residence permit for studies is granted for the period necessary for achieving the goal of stay on the territory of Poland, however the duration cannot be longer than 3 years. [European Commission](#)

Renewal conditions and documentation are the same as the original application: conditions for renewal: the same as above. [European Commission](#)

9. Changing to a Work Permit After Studies

Yes, Poland has a defined transition route open to graduates: change of status: possible if conditions for other status are met. Right to apply for a temporary residence permit for the purpose of job-searching or setting up a business after the completion of studies. [European Commission](#)

One restriction to flag: holders of a temporary residence permit for the purpose of studying at a higher education institution cannot apply for a temporary residence permit for the purpose of performing work as part of an intra-corporate transfer. Outside that specific category, though, the standard jobseeker/business-creation route and standard work-based residence permits remain open once you graduate and find employment or set up a business. [European Commission](#)

10. Official Government Information

The two authoritative sources are:

- **study.gov.pl** — the official Polish government portal for international students, covering visas and applications
- **mos.cudzoziemcy.gov.pl** (the Foreigners' Service portal, run by the Office for Foreigners) — for detailed legal procedures, documents, and the temporary residence permit process
- **gov.pl/web/diplomacy** — the Ministry of Foreign Affairs site, including the visa fee schedule and list of approved health insurers

For appeals and legal recourse: a third-country national not satisfied with a decision concerning granting the residence permit may appeal before the Head of the Office for

Foreigners within 14 days. Moreover, it is possible to bring a further appeal before the administrative courts. For visa refusals specifically: a third-country national who received a negative decision on issuing a visa may submit in person within 14 days a request to a consul for re-examination of the application. [European Commission](#)

11. Official Application Forms

- The **national visa application form** is available through the e-Konsulat portal (secure.e-konsulat.gov.pl) and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs visa pages (gov.pl/web/diplomacy/visas).
- The **temporary residence permit application form** and detailed instructions are hosted on the Office for Foreigners' portal at mos.cudzoziemcy.gov.pl (English-language section available), under the "na studia" (for studies) information pages.

12. Common Mistakes & Tips

- **Applying too close to your visa expiry** — since the temporary residence permit application must be submitted no later than on the last day of the lawful residence, leaving it to the last minute risks falling out of legal status if the Voivodship Office appointment isn't available in time. Book early. [European Commission](#)
- **Incomplete documentation at submission** — both the visa and residence permit processes give you only a short window (7 days) to supply missing documents before the application is rejected or returned, so double-check your file before submitting.
- **Underestimating health insurance requirements** — the 30,000 EUR minimum coverage for visa applicants is specific and not all travel insurance policies meet it; verify against the approved insurer list on gov.pl before purchasing.
- **Confusing the monthly financial threshold** — the 776 PLN figure is calculated *after* deducting accommodation costs, and it's separate from tuition and return-travel cost proof. Applicants sometimes only show one piece of this and get asked for more documentation.
- **Assuming all institutions are pre-approved** — if you're enrolling somewhere outside the standard public/recognized HEI category, check the Minister of Interior's approval list, since unapproved institutions can't sponsor a valid student visa application.
- **Missing the post-study transition deadline** — the jobseeker/business-creation residence permit needs to be applied for before your student permit expires, so plan your post-graduation timeline in advance rather than waiting to see if you find a job first.

1. Study Courses (Gemini)

To qualify for an Irish-equivalent national long-term D-type study visa in Poland, you must be enrolled in an approved course at an accredited institution:

- Full-time higher education programs (Bachelor's, Master's, or PhD programs) at a recognized Polish university.
- Preparatory courses for studying in Polish or English (foundation years).
- Part-time, weekend, or online courses **do not** qualify for a full national student visa.

2. Embassy Appointment

Visa applications are managed via Poland's official e-consulate platform or through third-party visa centers.

- You must register and complete your online application form on the official **e-Konsulat** website (e-konsulat.gov.pl).
- Depending on your location, you will use the system to draw or book a specific slot at the nearest Polish Embassy/Consulate or an authorized **VFS Global** visa application center.

3. Applying for a Study Visa

The application procedure follows these primary milestones:

1. **Secure admission** to a recognized Polish university and receive an official acceptance letter.
 2. **Pay your tuition fees** (typically for the first semester or full first year) and secure a formal payment receipt.
 3. **Register on e-Konsulat**, complete the National Visa (Type D) form, and print it out.
 4. **Attend your appointment** to submit your physical application file and enroll your biometrics.
- **Processing time:** The official processing timeframe is up to **15 days** from your submission, but it can extend to **30 days** or more during peak summer periods before the October semester starts. Apply at least 2 months in advance.

4. Documents Needed

When attending your visa appointment, you must present a organized physical file:

- A valid passport (valid for at least 3 months beyond your intended stay).
- Completed and signed **National Visa Application Form** printed from e-Konsulat.
- Official **Acceptance Certificate** from the Polish university.
- Proof of tuition payment (bank transfer receipt or university confirmation).
- Proof of **Schengen-compliant travel medical insurance** with a minimum coverage of **€30,000**, including repatriation.
- Proof of accommodation in Poland (dormitory allocation or a signed rental lease agreement).
- Comprehensive **financial proofs** showing self-sufficiency.

5. Money Requirements

The Polish government expects you to demonstrate that you can comfortably cover your living costs, housing, and return transit without public assistance:

- **Base Funds:** You must show a minimum base of accessible funds, typically around **PLN 8,000** (~€1,850) in an open account, plus separate coverage for your upcoming rent/housing costs.
- **Monthly Calculations:** For temporary stays, immigration requires at least **PLN 1,010 per month** for single students, plus a mandatory return travel allowance of **PLN 2,500** if you are coming from outside the EU.
- **Format:** You must present **3 to 6 months of consecutive bank statements** bearing official bank stamps. Sudden lump-sum transfers right before application without clear origin documentation (e.g., a registered educational loan or inheritance certificate) can lead to a visa refusal.

6. Residence Permit

A D-type visa allows entry and covers your first year. If your course extends past the visa expiration date, you must apply for a temporary residence permit (**Karta Pobytu**).

- **Where to apply:** You must apply at the local Voivodeship Office (*Urząd Wojewódzki*, Department for Foreigners) matching your place of residence in Poland.
- **When to apply:** Applications must be submitted in person before your current visa expires.
- **The Process:** You will submit an application form, pay a processing fee of **PLN 340**, and provide updated college enrollment documents. Once approved, you

will receive a plastic Karta Pobytu card (Stamp: *Student with Access to the Labor Market*).

7. Working While Studying

Poland has one of the most progressive work-study policies in Europe for international students.

- **Hours Allowed:** There is **no legal limit on working hours** for full-time students enrolled in recognized higher education institutions holding a valid Type D student visa or a Karta Pobytu. You can work full-time (up to 40 hours per week) if it does not interfere with your class attendance.
- **Requirement:** You do not need a separate work permit, but you will need a Polish tax identification number (**PESEL**) to be legally onboarded by an employer.

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

If your academic curriculum stretches across multiple years, you must renew your temporary residence status annually.

- **How to renew:** Applications can be drafted through the government's centralized Case Handling Module portal (**MOS** at mos.cudzoziemcy.gov.pl).
- You must submit proof of continuous health insurance, updated bank files confirming sufficient remaining funds, and a certificate from your university confirming your progression into the subsequent academic term.

9. Changing to a Work Permit

Upon completing a full-time university program in Poland, graduates get immediate access to the domestic job pool.

- **Job Search Extension:** Graduates can apply for a one-time temporary residence permit valid for up to **9 months** specifically to seek work or launch a startup.
- **Exemption from Work Permits:** Graduates of full-time Polish university programs are **permanently exempt** from requiring a work permit. Once you find a job, you directly apply for a unified Temporary Residence and Work Permit (*Zezwolenie na pobyt czasowy i pracę*), skipping the labor market test.

10. Official Information

Always check official channels for up-to-date immigration requirements:

- **The Republic of Poland Official Portal:** gov.pl/web/udsc-en (Office for Foreigners)
- **The Case Handling Module Portal:** mos.cudzoziemcy.gov.pl

11. Application Forms

- National visa forms are completed and generated via the **e-Konsulat portal** (e-konsulat.gov.pl).
- Local residence permit forms and instructional guides are downloaded or filled out interactively via the **MOS platform**.

12. Tips for Students (Common Mistakes to Avoid)

- **Ignoring the Local Registration (Zameldowanie):** After signing a private rental contract, many students forget to register their address at the city hall (*Urząd Miasta*). This registration document is frequently demanded when processing your Karta Pobytu.
- **Inadequate Medical Insurance Policy:** Submitting basic travel insurance that lacks explicit provisions for "repatriation of remains" or "emergency medical evacuation" is a common trap. Ensure your policy clearly prints out the €30,000 threshold and Schengen validity.
- **Failing University Classes:** To renew your residence permit, your university must submit a transcript verifying your academic progress. Failing multiple courses or skipping mandatory lectures can lead the Voivodeship office to cancel your residence permit due to lack of academic progression.